1d

Saigon in a Day

One day in Saigon, planned from official sources.

Một ngày Sài Gòn, đúng nguồn, đúng gu.

A bilingual planning assistant for short-stay international visitors to Ho Chi Minh City

Pitch deck for HIST 2026 · Theme: Digital transformation and AI in tourism

Lion, founder · [contact email / phone]

Version 1 · November 2026

Independent student project. Not affiliated with or endorsed by any government body or venue.

01 · PROBLEM

Short-stay visitors plan their one day in Saigon from scattered, often outdated information

Scattered sources

Visitors who stay one or two days piece together a route from blogs, social posts and general-purpose AI chatbots.

Wrong or outdated details

Opening hours, prices and closures change. Chatbots can confidently suggest places that are closed or do not exist.

Lost time, same few sites

Routes cut across heavy traffic, and visitors default to the same famous landmarks. Smaller museums and local experiences are rarely found.

Real examples from our own data research (Nov 2026): the Ho Chi Minh Museum branch at Nhà Rồng has been closed for renovation since 7 May 2026; the Notre-Dame Cathedral interior was reported closed for restoration; and four city museums changed their adult fee to 60,000 VND from 1 October 2026, while older guides still show other hours and prices.

02 · WHY IT MATTERS

The city is growing fast and has made digital tourism a stated priority

~8.6M

international visitors to Ho Chi Minh City in 2025, **up 40.3%**

~46M

domestic visitors in 2025, up 20%

US$10.6B

tourism revenue (VND 278,566 billion), up 45.8%

City ambition

Become Asia's leading creative tourism hub by 2030, focusing on high-value visitors, green tourism and digital tourism.

What this means for us

At this volume, even a small improvement in trip planning can extend stays, spread spending to more sites and strengthen the city's reputation.

Source: Sai Gon Giai Phong (SGGP), "Ho Chi Minh City welcomes nearly 8.6 million international visitors in 2025", 31 December 2025.

03 · SOLUTION

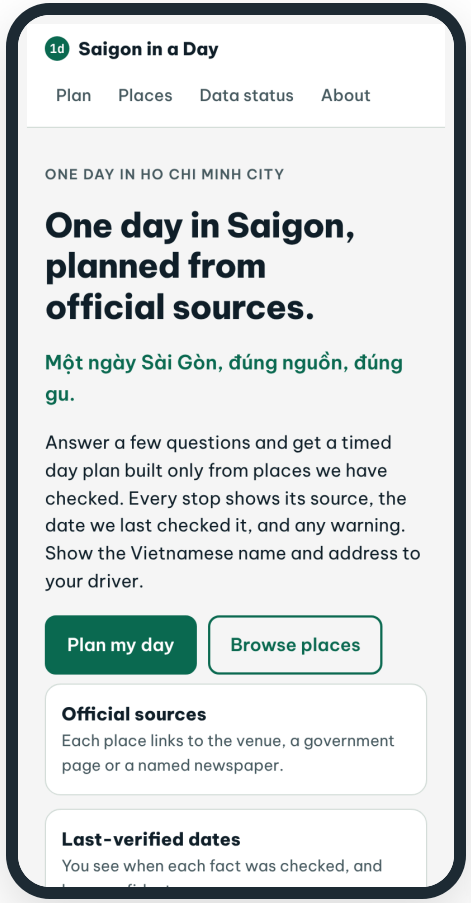
A timed one-day plan built only from places we have verified

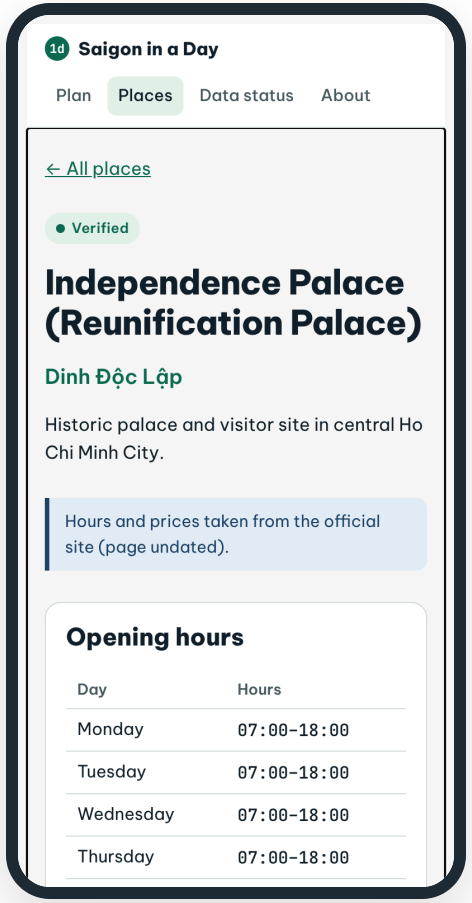
1. **Ask.** Interests, budget, hotel area, date and time window, mobility, group type, optional evening.
2. **Select.** Draw only from a curated database built from official public sources. Nothing outside it is ever suggested.
3. **Order.** Arrange stops by location, opening hours and travel time into a timed plan with a lunch window.
4. **Show.** English guidance plus Vietnamese names and addresses on a "show to driver" card.
5. **Correct.** Visitors report wrong information; we check and fix the database.

Trust by design

- Every stop shows its **source link** and a **"last verified" date**.
- Warnings for closed days, renovations and conflicting sources.
- When we do not have a verified answer, the assistant **says so instead of guessing**.
- A deterministic planning engine does the work. An AI layer is optional and is never allowed to add places, prices or hours.

A working mobile-first prototype, built and tested





What is built (prototype v1, November 2026)

- Questionnaire and timed day planner
- Place pages with sources, verification status and warnings
- "Show to driver" card with Vietnamese name and address
- "Report wrong information" button and short anonymous survey
- Data status page that shows openly what is and is not verified
- Deterministic planning engine with 10 automated tests

Honest status: real plans switch on once at least 8 places have verified coordinates and visit times. Until then, the planner says it does not have enough data, and a preview labelled "fictional test data" shows how a full plan looks.
Demo link: [paste public prototype link after sharing]

Others present information or generate plans. We plan from verified local data.

OPTION TODAY	TIMED DAY PLAN	VISIBLE SOURCES AND DATES	LIMITS (FROM PUBLIC REPORTS)
Official channels 3D/360 tourism map, reported tourism chatbot	Not observed yet [test]	Official content	Focus on presenting information about sites; planning features not yet tested by us
Global AI planners and chatbots	**Yes**	No	Reviews point to accuracy and trust gaps; no verified local database
Blogs, social, review sites	Partly	Rarely	Rich but scattered and often outdated
Local human guides	**Yes**	Personal knowledge	Reliable but costly and fixed in schedule
Saigon in a Day	**Yes**	**Yes, every stop**	**Hard to copy:** the verified local dataset, a correction loop from real visitor feedback, and relationships with sites and hotels built during the pilot

Sources: Tuoi Tre News (3D/360 map, Dec 2023); Doanh Nghiep Hoi Nhap (tourism chatbot, Sep 2023); Hospitality Today (AI travel tools reliability, 21 Aug 2025). We will test the official channels with real questions before the screening round and update this slide.

06 · MARKET

Start with one clear user in one city, then grow through hotels and tour operators

Context

~8.6M

international visitors to HCMC in 2025 (SGGP). This is the wider pool, not our addressable market.

Beachhead users

Independent short-stay visitors

First-time international travellers on a one or two-day stay who do not speak Vietnamese.

Share of visitors who stay 1–2 days: **[find a published source]**

Paying customers

Hotels and tour operators

Businesses that answer "what should I do today?" for their guests every day.

Number of hotels / tour operators in central HCMC: **[find a published source]**

Secondary beneficiaries: museums, cultural sites, small local businesses and evening experiences gain visibility. Later, city tourism bodies could gain anonymised, privacy-respecting insight into visitor interests. Market sizing will be filled only with sourced figures; we do not estimate without data.

07 · BUSINESS MODEL

Free for travellers. Hotels and tour operators pay.

Travellers

Free

The full planner, driver cards and sources at no cost. Trust is the product; no paywall between a visitor and correct information.

Main revenue

B2B white-label plans

Hotels and tour operators offer the planner to guests under their own brand, by QR code at reception or in pre-arrival messages.

Secondary

Featured listings

Verified local businesses can pay for visibility, always **clearly labelled** as featured and never ranked above the visitor's own needs.

Later

Anonymised insights

Aggregate trends on visitor interests for partners. No personal data collected or sold.

First step: pilot with 3–5 hotels

Offer the planner free during the pilot, measure guest use and satisfaction, then agree a paid plan with the hotels that see value.

Prices to validate in the pilot (assumptions):
White-label: 1.5M VND per partner per month + 2M setup fee
Featured listing: 500k VND per month
Pilot hotels confirmed: **[0 of 3–5 so far — update]**

08 · TRACTION

Early stage, stated honestly: product built, data started, users next

1
working prototype with a tested planning engine

15
places researched from official and news sources, with links and dates

1
place fully verified so far (Independence Palace); 5 partly verified

0
real users or partners yet. The pilot starts next.

Data status of the 15 places (2 Nov 2026)



1 verified · 5 partial · 7 need data · 1 exterior only · 1 temporarily closed

Pilot results to add (only real numbers):
Visitors surveyed: **[n]** · found one-day planning difficult: **[x%]** · met wrong information online: **[y%]** · rated our plan realistic: **[z%]** · NPS: **[ ]**

Partner progress to add:
Hotels contacted / interested / piloting: **[ ] / [ ] / [ ]**
Places verified on site: **[ ]** · Error reports fixed: **[ ]**

09 · TEAM

A founder who works directly with the target user

Lion — Founder

- First-year student, Computer Science (AI for Business, honours programme)
- Coursework in programming, databases, statistics, machine learning, marketing and entrepreneurship
- Works guiding foreign tourists in English: direct access to the people the product is for, and to on-the-ground checks of places
- Strong English; learning Chinese (HSK), a future second language for the product

University name: **[ ]** · Guiding since: **[month/year]** · Contact / LinkedIn: **[ ]**

How the work gets done

- Product and code built with AI-assisted development, reviewed by the founder
- Data verified by the founder from official pages and on tours
- Built in small, fixed weekly blocks alongside study

People we are looking for

Co-founder or advisors (e.g. hospitality, tourism, business development): **[add names if any, or state "seeking"]**

10 · FINANCIALS

Lean to run. Every figure below is an untested assumption, not a result.

Base scenario · assumptions · VND, before tax

	2027	2028	2029
Paying hotel / tour-operator partners (avg)	1	6	15
Labelled featured listings (avg)	0	8	20
Anonymised insight reports	0	1	2
Revenue	**20M**	**181M**	**528M**
Costs	**4.9M**	**79.5M**	**326.6M**
Operating result	**15.1M**	**101.5M**	**201.4M**
Revenue in USD (≈26,280 VND/USD)	~$0.8k	~$6.9k	~$20.1k

Low and High scenarios scale all volumes by 0.5× and 1.5×. Full model: saigon-in-a-day-financial-model.xlsx.

Assumed prices and costs

- Travellers: **free** (a design decision)
- White-label: 1.5M VND/month (2.0M from 2029) + 2M setup fee per new partner
- Featured listing: 500k VND/month · insight report: 15M VND
- Founder unpaid in 2027; stipend 3M/month in 2028, 8M/month in 2029; part-time help from 2029
- AI cost is a placeholder (300 VND/plan); the planner also works with AI switched off

Funding ask: [amount] for **[use]** over **[months]**. Leave out if not raising.

Traction today: no users, partners, revenue or pilot. All prices and volumes will be validated in partner interviews and the hotel pilot. Exchange rate derived from SGGP, 31 Dec 2025.

From prototype to a real pilot with visitors and hotels

Nov 2026

Data and rules

Read HIST rules; verify places with coordinates and visit times; test official channels.

Dec 2026

Small blocks

Reach 8+ plannable places so real plans switch on. Limited time during exams.

After exams, early 2027

Public MVP

Deploy publicly; 12–20 verified plannable places; privacy page and disclaimer live.

After launch

Pilot

Survey real visitors (aim n ≥ 30); pilot with 3–5 hotels; report results with counts.

Targets we will report against

- 20, then 40 verified plannable places
- 100% of plannable places re-checked within 90 days
- At least 70% of surveyed users rate the plan realistic

Targets are proposals, not promises.

What we ask from HIST 2026

- Mentoring on B2B sales to hotels and tour operators
- Introductions to hotels and venues for the pilot
- Feedback from tourism experts on the data approach

Edit to match your real ask.